

For starters, the store isn't available on all chrome computers. Even if you have a compatible device, you would still have to pass through compatibility requirements of the individual apps. The situation gets a little more tricky at this point: due to lack of certain hardware which can be found on phones or the fact that the Play Store considers Chrome OS computers as tablets, a lot of apps cannot be used on the platform. Google has promised to fix this issues and make the application experience as seamless as on the smartphones. These apps either open in their unique windows or the browser window. You can also pin these apps on the shelf. It's a region on the bottom edge of the OS which allows people to pin shortcuts to apps or web pages to quickly access them. Right next to the shelf is the OS' own version of the start menu. It's called the App Menu and it opens up Google search page along with some of the recent apps you've used and a button to expand this list to all your apps. Below these are Google Now cards, which are same as all the other platforms. On the other side of the shelf is the system tray which shows important information like battery life, Wi-Fi signal and cellular connection if available. It can also be opened to access the settings section of the OS for more customisation options. There's also a notifications tab right next to this tray. Remote access is also supported through the Chrome Remote Desktop.

Security

The OS uses a sandbox security mechanism that separates each running program into their own unique process and directory, and restricts them from communicating with each other directly. This reduces system failures and prevents vulnerabilities from spreading to other programs. All Chrome-approved hardware is supposed to be manufactured with Trusted Platform Modules – these are chips which are designed following a set of international standards, and use cryptography to secure your data, even in the event that your system receives a physical attack. Chrome OS actually claims to be the most secure consumer OS, because the system checks for compromises at boot, and the initial boot-code that does this is stored in read-only-memory that cannot be modified!

Releases

The releases are split into four channels - stable, beta, dev and canary. Stable is obviously the one that is recommended to consumers. It's the one with the longest update time between versions, but it's also the most stable